FOR BUSY MEN OVER 30

The Five Foundations

Five things that fit round work and kids. Get them done most weeks and everything else gets easier.

01 Protein at every meal

02 Daily steps

03 Three short sessions a week

04 Sleep

05 One weekly check-in

Foundations beat motivation.

Sunday night you mean it. By Wednesday work's run late and the session's gone. By Saturday the weekend has undone the week.

That isn't a willpower problem. Motivation gets you to week two. Structure gets you the rest of the way. This guide is that structure, cut down to five things. None of them need an hour a day, and none of them need you to feel like it.

HOW TO USE IT

01 Every foundation has a target and a minimum. Hit the target when you can. Hit the minimum when the week goes sideways.

02 Print the tracker on page 8, or screenshot it. Tick each one off as you go.

03 Do your check-in once a week. Change one thing at a time, never five.

04 Aim for most days, not every day. Miss one? Pick it back up at the next meal.

WHO I AM

I'm Callum. I coach men over 30 online, one to one. For years willpower never once saved me. Structure did. That's what I coach, and this is where it starts.

01 Protein at every meal

A proper portion of protein on every plate, roughly 30 to 40g a meal. Not a daily total you're chasing at 9pm.

WHY IT MATTERS

Past 30, hanging on to muscle takes more effort than it used to. Protein is how you protect it while the fat comes off. It keeps you full too, which helps when there's a tin of biscuits in the office.

THE MINIMUM

A real protein source at every meal, even if you don't weigh it. **4 large eggs, 250g fat-free Greek yoghurt or a scoop of whey** is around 25g. About 100g of cooked chicken breast is around 30g.

FIT IT IN

Pick a breakfast and a lunch and repeat them every weekday. That's two meals you never have to think about. Cooking for the kids? Do extra chicken or mince and that's tomorrow's lunch sorted. Keep a shake or a tin of tuna in your bag or desk for the days that go wrong.

THE TRAP

Coffee for breakfast, a meal deal for lunch, then a huge dinner to catch up. You can get a day's protein in one sitting. I've done it plenty of times. But when you're getting back into things, spread it out. 30 to 40g a meal is a good amount for muscle repair and growth (protein synthesis), and it keeps you fuller all day.

☐ TICK THE DAY WHEN

Every meal had a proper portion of protein

02 Daily steps

Walking, counted. Your phone's already doing it. I start my clients on 10,000 a day and you build up to it.

WHY IT MATTERS

Across a week, your steps burn more than any one gym session. They don't eat into your recovery and you don't need a babysitter. Desk, car, sofa: most of us barely move outside the gym.

THE MINIMUM

Look up your daily average for last week. **Beat it by 1,000 to 2,000 steps a day.** That's roughly 10 to 20 minutes of walking. Once that's normal, add another 1,000 until you're at 10,000.

FIT IT IN

Walk the school run, or park further away. Take phone calls on your feet. Ten minutes after lunch and ten after dinner adds up quicker than you'd think. At the park with the kids, walk laps instead of standing by the swings.

THE TRAP

Saving it all for the weekend. One big Saturday doesn't make up for a week sat down. Daily beats heroic.

☐ TICK THE DAY WHEN

You hit your step target

03 Three short sessions a week

Three full-body strength sessions, about 45 minutes each. A squat, a push, a pull and a hinge, done properly.

WHY IT MATTERS

You don't need to live in the gym. Three focused sessions is enough to get stronger and keep your muscle while the fat comes off. Getting stronger makes the rest of life easier too: the kids, the shopping, your back.

THE MINIMUM

Two sessions on a bad week. Short on time? Do the main lifts and go home. 30 minutes done beats an hour skipped. Stop most sets 2 to 3 reps short of failure, write down what you lifted, and next time add a rep or a bit of weight.

FIT IT IN

Book them in like meetings. Same three days every week, say Monday, Wednesday and Friday. If evenings keep getting taken off you, train before work. Bag packed the night before. Miss Monday? Do it Tuesday. Don't try to cram two into one day.

THE TRAP

Going all out in week one, being wrecked for a fortnight, then packing it in. Leave a bit in the tank so you come back on Wednesday.



TICK THE DAY WHEN

You trained. Three ticks by Sunday

04 Sleep

Seven to nine hours a night. It's the cheapest upgrade you've got, and it's the first thing busy men give up.

WHY IT MATTERS	Short sleep makes you hungrier, flattens your sessions and slows your recovery. Tired at 3pm is when the biscuits and the extra coffee happen. Get this right and the other four get a lot easier.
THE MINIMUM	**A set wake time, and a bedtime that gives you 7 hours.** Kids up in the night? You can't control that. You can control when you go to bed.
FIT IT IN	Set an alarm for bedtime, not just the morning. If the kids have you up at 6, you're in bed by 11. Charge your phone outside the bedroom. Last coffee by early afternoon.
THE TRAP	Staying up because it's the only time that's yours. Kids are down, the house is finally quiet, and suddenly it's 1am. I get it. But you pay for it the next day with your food, your training and your mood.

☐ TICK THE DAY WHEN

You got 7 hours or more

05 One weekly check-in

Ten minutes once a week. Your 7-day average weight and your waist, written down and compared with last week.

WHY IT MATTERS	Your weight moves every day with water, salt, food and sleep. React to that and you'll quit over a number that was never real. The weekly average shows the direction. The tape shows if it's fat coming off.
HOW TO TAKE IT	**Weight:** every morning after the toilet, before food or drink. Add the week up and divide by how many days you weighed. **Waist:** once a week, first thing, relaxed, tape round your belly button. Don't suck in.
THE MINIMUM	Weigh in on at least 4 mornings and measure your waist once. Write both down.
FIT IT IN	Same slot every week. Sunday morning with a brew works. Count how many foundations you hit. Hit them and nothing's moved for two weeks? Change one thing. Just one.
THE TRAP	One bad morning on the scales, then five changes at once. Whatever happens next, you won't know why.

☐ TICK THE WEEK WHEN

Average and waist are written down

YOUR WEEK

Week starting _____ Tick a box every time you hit one. Aim for most days, not every day.

FOUNDATION	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
01 Protein Every meal							
02 Steps Target: _____							
03 Training 3 sessions a week							
04 Sleep 7 hours or more							
05 Check-in Once a week							

MORNING WEIGHT	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
kg							

7-DAY AVERAGE THIS WEEK	7-DAY AVERAGE LAST WEEK

WAIST THIS WEEK (CM)	WAIST LAST WEEK (CM)

THE ONE THING I'LL CHANGE NEXT WEEK

Want me to build this around your week?

The five foundations work. What this guide can't do is look at your job, your kids and your numbers and tell you the one thing to change next.

That's what I do with my one-to-one clients, online, every week. Your targets get set to you, I read your check-in myself, and the plan is built round the week you actually have.

Applying is free, takes about two minutes and doesn't commit you to anything. I read every application myself, and if I can't help I'll tell you straight.

TAP TO APPLY

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OR SAY HELLO ON INSTAGRAM

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NOT MEDICAL ADVICE

This guide is general guidance on training, nutrition and lifestyle. It isn't medical advice. If you have a health condition or take any medication, speak to your GP before changing your diet or training. Train within your ability and stop if anything causes pain.